

So I've been truly blessed by the magical combination of my Scottish thrift genes; my generous compensation; my propensity to save whatever remains each year; the mathematical miracle of tax-free compounding; the knowledge that in investing, costs matter enormously; and enough common sense to focus on a balanced asset allocation. I've talked this talk endlessly. Now that I've walked its walk personally, I can assure you that it's true. It works!

Enough for You?

Whoever cultivates the Golden Mean avoids both the poverty of a hovel and the envy of a palace.

That's the standard that the Roman poet Horace urged upon us some two millennia ago, and it is an equally valid standard today. My own resources surely place me within that Golden Mean, if clearly on the high side; indeed, relative to those in our society at large, in the higher reaches among U.S. citizens.

I'm confident that virtually all of you who are reading this book also fall within the Golden Mean that Horace described. Over years of meeting thousands of Vanguard shareholders—and receiving letters and e-mails from thousands more—I've learned that many of them (indeed, most of them) are confident that they have accumulated enough to satisfy their own needs and desires. I can hardly find the words to express how delighted I am that my humble vision of how to invest successfully has played a key role in that outcome.

When John D. Rockefeller was asked how much was enough, he answered, "Just a little bit more." But for most of us, as it is said, *enough* is \$1 more than you need. And that's a pretty good way to look at it. But the question is more complicated than that. A *Wall Street Journal* book review of *Whatever Happened to Thrift?* recently tried to answer the question "Do Americans have enough?" with this wise answer: "That depends on what the meaning of the word 'enough' is. Enough for our own good? Enough for that of our